West Berlin—Der Deutsche Reichstag) to temporarily envelop in fabric the destroyed former seat of German government next to the Wall. The pair had previously issued a manifesto of sorts toward wrapping monumental buildings as a form of artistic intervention.[26] Christo and Jeanne-Claude created a vision for this project remotely with the help from city residents, until they visited divided Berlin for the first time in 1976.

The selection of the Reichstag as the project site was a way for the artists to engage the division of the city while pursuing a project that could be visible on both sides. The Wall was not off-limits for smaller artistic disruptions, like Kaprow's, but Christo and Jeanne-Claude imagined a much larger civic intervention. The decision to wrap the Reichstag called into question the practical dynamics of Berlin's fragmented governance. Jennifer Mundy notes, "The Reichstag was then under the jurisdiction of both East and West Berlin authorities. It was scarcely used, but such was the tension between the two governments, and the political sensitivity of the site, that the project to wrap the building was rejected three times."[27] The ruined iconic stone facade of the Reichstag was to be consumed by massive unfurled spools of fabric, visible from both sides, which simultaneously would conjure and withhold its sculptural form. Wieland Schmied adds, "The state of a wrapped object not only has negative aspect that the object is withdrawn, estranged from us; it also contains its formal qualities."[28] Along the wasteland of central Berlin's hardened border, Christo and Jeanne-Claude imagined an added visual system intended to treat the traumatized structure of the Reichstag and the Wall adjacent as a call to heal both monumental structures.

For three decades, Christo and Jeanne-Claude's Reichstag project lived solely in multiple iterations of large collages, before its eventual implementation years after the city's reunification in 1995. The first iteration, credited to Christo in 1972, is an assemblage that incorporates "pencil, charcoal, pastel, wax crayon, fabric, staples, photographs, map and tape," a diverse materiality that as an artistic proposal mirrored the space near the Wall, too, as an ensemble of material components. Later versions of collages also included fabric, twine, wood, and paint; the images incorporated representations of the outermost barrier of the Berlin Wall but dwarfed in comparison with the enormous Reichstag. Other additions involved alterations of the name of the work itself—for example, changing "West Berlin" to "Berlin" in 1977. The Wall could not be enveloped through